Digital Savvy Studios

A FREE FIELD GUIDE FOR FOUNDERS

THE LAUNCH VISIBILITY CHECKLIST

12 checks before your next *launch, raise or market entry.*

A practical guide to how the market sees your brand, and what to fix first when the budget is tight.



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BEFORE YOU START

A note from *Janefrances.*

I wrote this guide for the founders I meet who are doing serious work but can't yet afford a strategist. You have a good product. Customers who find you tend to love you. And still, the enquiries don't match the effort.

Most of the time, the problem isn't the business. It's the gap between how good you are and how good you look to a stranger who has never heard of you. That stranger is your next customer, your next investor and your next partner, and they decide very quickly.

These are the same 12 checks my team runs before every launch, raise and market entry we work on. None of them needs a big budget. Most of them need an honest hour and the discipline to fix one thing at a time.

Be honest with yourself as you go. A low score today is far cheaper than a launch that lands quietly.

Janefrances

How to use this guide

1. Set aside an hour.
Work through all 12 checks in one sitting, ideally with one person from your team.

2. Tick only what's true today.
Not what you're planning, and not what was true last year. If you're unsure, leave it unticked.

3. Score yourself.
Count your ticks on the scorecard page and read what your score means.

4. Fix in order.
Start with the part where you scored lowest, then follow the 30-day plan. Templates are at the back.

THE FOUR PARTS

What a stranger checks *before they trust you.*

Every serious buyer runs the same quiet test before they reach out. They search your name, open your Instagram and your website, look up the founder, and ask someone who knows you. This guide is organised around what they're looking for.

PART 1

Positioning

Can people tell, quickly, who you're for and why you win?

CHECKS 1 TO 3

PART 2

Proof

Is there evidence you deliver, and can a stranger find it?

CHECKS 4 TO 6

PART 3

Content and channels

Do you show up consistently, well, and in the right places?

CHECKS 7 TO 9

PART 4

Systems

When someone is interested, does anything happen next?

CHECKS 10 TO 12

THE RULE BEHIND EVERY CHECK

Your brand is only as strong as what a stranger finds in the first 60 seconds. They can't see how hard you work. They can only see what's in front of them.

PART 1 OF 4

Positioning

Everything else in this guide depends on this part. If people can't tell who you're for and why you win, better content and more ads only make the confusion louder.

CHECK 1

You can say who you're for and why you win in one sentence, and your whole team says it the same way.

WHY IT MATTERS

When three people on your team describe you three different ways, buyers hear three different companies, and they trust none of them. Clarity is the cheapest marketing upgrade there is.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Send three people on your team the same WhatsApp message, separately: "In one sentence, who do we help and why do they choose us?"
2. Put their answers next to your Instagram bio, your LinkedIn About section and your homepage headline.
3. If the five don't say roughly the same thing, leave this box unticked.

> **FIX IT THIS WEEK**
>
> Fill in this sentence: "We help [specific customer] [get a specific result] without [the thing they hate]." Share it with everyone who speaks for the brand and use it, word for word, as the first line everywhere for the next 90 days.

What good looks like *"We help busy Lagos professionals keep their skin clear through harmattan and humidity, without a ten-step routine."*

CHECK 2

Your homepage headline names your customer and the result you deliver, not your history or your technology.

WHY IT MATTERS

A stranger decides in a few seconds whether you're for them. "Founded in 2019" and "innovative solutions" make them work to find out, and most won't.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Show your homepage to someone outside your industry for five seconds, then close it.
2. Ask them three questions: What do we do? Who is it for? What should you do next?
3. Two or more wrong answers means your headline is working against you.

> **FIX IT THIS WEEK**
>
> Rewrite the top of the page in this order: a headline that names the result for the customer, one line that explains how, one button. Move the company story further down the page, where people who are already interested will read it.

What good looks like *Before: "Innovative financial solutions for modern businesses." After: "Payroll for Nigerian SMEs, done in ten minutes a month."*

CHECK 3

You know the three questions buyers ask before they trust you, and your content answers them.

WHY IT MATTERS

Questions nobody answers become silent objections. Buyers rarely ask twice. They simply go quiet and buy from whoever answered first.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Scroll back through your last 20 enquiries in DMs, WhatsApp and email.
2. Write down every question people asked before they paid.
3. Circle the three that come up most.

> **FIX IT THIS WEEK**
>
> Turn each of those three questions into something people can find without asking: a pinned post or Story highlight, a short FAQ block on your website, and a saved reply your team can send in seconds.

What good looks like *An events caterer pins three highlights: "Do you cater outside Lagos?", "What's your minimum guest count?" and "How early should I book?"*

YOUR NOTES ON POSITIONING

TRUE TODAY

WHAT I'LL FIX FIRST

WHO OWNS IT, AND BY WHEN

PART 2 OF 4

Proof

People believe what others say about you far more than what you say about yourself. This part is about making sure the evidence exists and that a stranger can find it.

CHECK 4

You have at least three specific, shareable results, each with a real number.

WHY IT MATTERS

"Great service" convinces nobody. "Cut delivery time from five days to two" does the selling for you, and it gives happy customers something specific to repeat.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Try to finish this sentence three times, honestly: "We helped [client] go from ___ to ___ in ___."
2. If you can't finish it three times without exaggerating, leave this box unticked.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Message three happy clients this week and ask two questions: "What was happening before you worked with us?" and "What changed?" Ask permission to quote them. Numbers don't have to be money. Time saved, enquiries gained and stress removed all count.

What good looks like *"Our clients' patients stopped missing appointments: no-shows dropped from one in four to one in ten within two months." (An illustration of the format, not a real client.)*

CHECK 5

Your founder is visible online with a clear point of view, not just a job title.

WHY IT MATTERS

Buyers with real money buy from people they believe in. A founder who shares how they think is the strongest trust signal a small brand has, and it costs nothing but time.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Search your own name, as a stranger would.
2. Look at your last ten posts on LinkedIn or Instagram.
3. Count how many share an opinion about your industry, compared with announcements and promotions.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Choose one platform and one belief about your industry you'd happily defend over dinner. Post twice a week for 90 days: one opinion, one story from the work. Consistency matters more than polish here.

What good looks like *A skincare founder posts every Tuesday about one ingredient myth she sees in Nigerian beauty stores, and every Friday about a customer's routine.*

CHECK 6

A stranger can find reviews, press or testimonials about you in under a minute.

WHY IT MATTERS

Before anyone pays you, they check what other people say. If they can't find anything, they assume there's nothing to find.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Open a private browser window on your phone and start a one-minute timer.
2. Search your brand name, then your brand name and "reviews".
3. Stop the timer when you find something a stranger would believe that you didn't write yourself.

> **FIX IT THIS WEEK**
>
> Claim and complete your Google Business Profile. Ask five happy clients for a Google review this week (there's a message template at the back of this guide). Pin your best testimonials on Instagram and add two or three of them near the top of your homepage.

What good looks like *Searching the brand name shows a Google profile with 23 reviews, a pinned "Clients" highlight and a short quote on the homepage.*

YOUR NOTES ON PROOF

TRUE TODAY

WHAT I'LL FIX FIRST

WHO OWNS IT, AND BY WHEN

PART 3 OF 4

Content and channels

Most small brands don't have a content problem. They have a focus problem. This part is about showing up well in fewer places.

CHECK 7

You publish on a plan, on the channels where your buyers actually spend their time.

WHY IT MATTERS

Showing up well in two places beats showing up thinly everywhere. Spreading yourself across five platforms usually means doing all five badly.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. List where your last ten customers first heard about you.
2. Next to it, list where you spent most of your marketing time last month.
3. If the two lists don't match, leave this box unticked.

> **FIX IT THIS WEEK**
>
> Pick the two channels that brought you the most customers. Set a weekly rhythm you could keep up for 12 weeks even in your busiest month, then keep it. A smaller plan you follow beats a big one you abandon.

What good looks like *Three Instagram posts and one LinkedIn article a week, planned every Monday morning in one hour.*

CHECK 8

The quality of your content matches the quality of your product.

WHY IT MATTERS

Buyers judge the product by how it's presented. Ordinary visuals make an excellent product look ordinary, and they invite people to compare you on price.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Screenshot your last nine posts as a grid.
2. Put it next to the grid of a brand your best customers admire.
3. Ask a friend: "Which of these two charges more?"

> **FIX IT THIS WEEK**
>
> Set three rules and stick to them: one pair of fonts, two brand colours, natural light. Retake your main product or team photos beside a window. Archive old posts that make you look cheaper than you are.

What good looks like *A consistent grid where every post uses the same two colours and every photo is taken in daylight.*

CHECK 9

Your launch plan covers the two weeks before and after launch day, not just the day itself.

WHY IT MATTERS

Most launches peak on day one and fade by day three, before buyers have had time to decide. People rarely buy the first time they hear about something.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Look back at your last launch.
2. Count the posts and messages you sent in the 14 days before, on the day itself, and in the 14 days after.

> **FIX IT THIS WEEK**
>
> Plan your next launch as one story over 28 days: talk about the problem (days 1 to 10), open the waiting list (11 to 14), launch day, share proof and answer questions (15 to 24), then a clear last call (25 to 28).

What good looks like *A bakery's Christmas hampers: two weeks of behind-the-scenes, a waiting list, launch day, then customer unboxings until the order deadline.*

YOUR NOTES ON CONTENT AND CHANNELS

TRUE TODAY

WHAT I'LL FIX FIRST

WHO OWNS IT, AND BY WHEN

PART 4 OF 4

Systems

Good marketing brings people to your door. Systems decide whether anyone answers. These three checks are where small brands quietly lose the most money.

CHECK 10

Every enquiry lands in one place and gets a reply within a working day.

WHY IT MATTERS

Fast replies win business. Slow ones hand it to whoever answered first. Buyers rarely wait, and they almost never chase.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. At 7pm on a weekday, send an enquiry to your own brand through every channel: Instagram DM, website form, email and WhatsApp.
2. Time how long it takes for someone to reply to each one.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Move enquiries into WhatsApp Business, with labels for new, quoted and paid. Give one person the job of replying each day. Send a short holding reply within an hour, even when the full answer takes longer (there's a template at the back).

What good looks like *Every new enquiry gets a personal holding reply within 30 minutes and a full answer the same day.*

CHECK 11

Repetitive marketing tasks are automated, not done by hand.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every hour spent copying, scheduling and chasing is an hour not spent selling or improving the product.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. For one week, write down every marketing task you do more than once.
2. Mark anything that takes more than 15 minutes a week and follows the same steps every time.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Start with three free or cheap tools: schedule posts in Meta Business Suite, set WhatsApp Business greeting and away messages, and send website enquiries straight into a Google Sheet so nothing gets lost.

What good looks like *Posts for the week are scheduled every Monday, and every enquiry is logged automatically with the date and source.*

CHECK 12

You know which channel brings your best customers, and your budget follows it.

WHY IT MATTERS

Spending evenly across channels quietly funds the weakest ones. Small budgets can't afford that.

TEST IT IN TEN MINUTES

1. Name the channel that brought your three highest-paying customers this year.
2. If you have to guess, leave this box unticked.

FIX IT THIS WEEK

Add "How did you hear about us?" to every enquiry form, order and first conversation. Review the answers on the last Friday of every month and move a fifth of your spend from the weakest channel to the strongest.

What good looks like *"Referrals and LinkedIn bring 70% of our revenue, so that's where most of our time and money goes."*

YOUR NOTES ON SYSTEMS

TRUE TODAY

WHAT I'LL FIX FIRST

WHO OWNS IT, AND BY WHEN

YOUR SCORECARD

Count your ticks. *Be honest.*

☐	1	You can say who you're for and why you win in one sentence, and your whole team says it the same way.	POSITIONING
☐	2	Your homepage headline names your customer and the result you deliver, not your history or your technology.	POSITIONING
☐	3	You know the three questions buyers ask before they trust you, and your content answers them.	POSITIONING
☐	4	You have at least three specific, shareable results, each with a real number.	PROOF
☐	5	Your founder is visible online with a clear point of view, not just a job title.	PROOF
☐	6	A stranger can find reviews, press or testimonials about you in under a minute.	PROOF
☐	7	You publish on a plan, on the channels where your buyers actually spend their time.	CONTENT AND CHANNELS
☐	8	The quality of your content matches the quality of your product.	CONTENT AND CHANNELS
☐	9	Your launch plan covers the two weeks before and after launch day, not just the day itself.	CONTENT AND CHANNELS
☐	10	Every enquiry lands in one place and gets a reply within a working day.	SYSTEMS
☐	11	Repetitive marketing tasks are automated, not done by hand.	SYSTEMS
☐	12	You know which channel brings your best customers, and your budget follows it.	SYSTEMS

10 to 12

Ready to scale.

Your foundations are strong. Protect your consistency, and put your energy into sharper positioning and bigger moments.

6 to 9

The gaps are costing you.

Buyers are noticing what's missing. Fix your weakest part first, then follow the 30-day plan.

0 to 5

Your product is ahead of your marketing.

Start with Part 1 only. Everything else in this guide depends on getting positioning right.

My score today _____ **/ 12** **Weakest part** _____

YOUR NEXT 30 DAYS

One part a week. *No more.*

Trying to fix everything at once is how good intentions die. If your score was low, follow this plan in order. If one part was already strong, use that week to go deeper on your weakest part instead.

WEEK 1

Positioning

- [ ] Write your one-sentence positioning and share it with your team.
- [ ] Rewrite your homepage headline, Instagram bio and LinkedIn About to match it.
- [ ] Turn your three most common buyer questions into a pinned post, an FAQ block and a saved reply.

WEEK 2

Proof

- [ ] Message three happy clients for their before-and-after story.
- [ ] Ask five clients for a Google review using the template at the back.
- [ ] Pin your best testimonials and add two to your homepage.

WEEK 3

Content and channels

- [ ] Find the two channels your last ten customers came from.
- [ ] Set a weekly posting rhythm you can keep for 12 weeks.
- [ ] Set your three visual rules and retake your main photos in daylight.

WEEK 4

Systems

- [ ] Move every enquiry into one inbox with one owner each day.
- [ ] Set up a holding reply, greeting and away messages.
- [ ] Add "How did you hear about us?" everywhere and book a monthly review.

AT THE END OF THE MONTH

Run all 12 checks again. Compare your score with today's. Every new tick is one less reason for a buyer to walk away.

TEMPLATES

Copy these. *Make them yours.*

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE POSITIONING

CHECK 1

We help _specific customer_ get _specific result_ without _the thing they hate_.

YOUR HOMEPAGE, TOP TO BOTTOM

CHECK 2

Headline: the result your customer gets. **One line:** how you deliver it. **Proof:** one short testimonial or number. **One button:** the single next step you want them to take.

A RESULT WORTH SHARING

CHECK 4

Client came to us with _problem_. In _time_, we _what you did_, and _result with a number_.

ASKING FOR A REVIEW

CHECK 6

Hi [name], working with you on [project] was a real pleasure. If we made a difference, would you leave us a two-line review here: [link]? It helps other [type of customer] find us. Thank you!

THE HOLDING REPLY

CHECK 10

Hi [name], thank you for reaching out to [brand]. I've seen your message and I'll come back to you with full details by [time] today. In the meantime, here's [one helpful link].

ASKING FOR A CLIENT'S STORY

CHECK 4

Hi [name], I'm putting together a few client stories and I'd love to include yours. Two quick questions: what was happening before we worked together, and what changed afterwards? A voice note is perfect.

WHEN YOU'RE READY

You don't need a big budget to look like *the brand you're becoming.*

You need clarity, proof and consistency, in that order. This guide gives you all three. Work through it, run it again in 30 days, and watch what changes.

Keep learning, free

Join The Visibility Brief, our occasional note on positioning and growth for founders. You're already on the list if this guide reached you by email.

Want a second pair of eyes?

Each month we run all 12 checks for 8 founders, free, in a Visibility Session. It's for brands preparing for a launch, raise or expansion and ready to invest ₦800,000 or more a month in marketing.

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